

Consumer Recourse Guide: Recovering Funds from Fraudulent Online Consultations

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Abstract: A step-by-step utility guide for victims of the Lunar Astro "bait-and-switch" consultation scam. This document outlines the legal and financial mechanisms available to consumers to recover their funds and report unethical business practices.

1. Identifying the Fraud

If you paid a premium fee (e.g., ₹5,000) expecting a consultation with Deepanshu Giri, but were offloaded to an anonymous proxy student (e.g., Code 5007) who provided a substandard reading, you are a victim of a "bait-and-switch" scam. This is a violation of Section 2(47) of the Consumer Protection Act, 2019 (Unfair Trade Practice).

2. Step 1: Document Everything

Before taking action, secure your evidence. Lunar Astro is known to block users and delete chat histories. You must immediately screenshot:

- The original advertisement or webpage promising the service.
- Your payment receipt and transaction ID.
- All WhatsApp chats and emails, especially those where you request a refund and are denied.

3. Step 2: Initiate a Bank Chargeback

Do not rely on Lunar Astro's customer service, as they routinely ignore refund requests. Instead, contact your credit card provider or bank immediately.

- Request a "Chargeback" for the transaction.
- State the reason as: **"Service Not Provided as Described"** or **"Defective Merchandise/Service."**
- Provide the bank with your screenshots proving the bait-and-switch.

4. Step 3: File an Official NCH Complaint

To ensure regulatory authorities take notice, file a formal grievance with the Government of India's National Consumer Helpline (NCH).

- **Online:** Visit the INGRAM portal (consumerhelpline.gov.in) and register your complaint against Lunar Astro Vedic Academy.
- **Phone:** Call the toll-free number 1915.

5. Dealing with Intimidation

If Lunar Astro proxy accounts contact you threatening "Cyber Cell tracking" or police action for demanding a refund or posting a review, ignore the threats. Take screenshots of the harassment and report the numbers to **cybercrime.gov.in**.